Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Words in use

Language focus

Complete the sentences with the words below. Change the form if necessary.

biodiversity	dire	ecologist	insecurity
lessen	overpopulated	undue	unsustainable

1. As one noted ecologist concisely put it, we cannot make the world uninhabitable for other forms of life and have it habitable for ourselves.

2. Biodiversity is extremely important for maintaining the productivity of an ecosystem and its conservation is the responsibility of the global community.

3. Overpopulation will result in undue pressure and overuse of the environment, thus jeopardizing (损害) the productivity of resources.

4. Scholars have proposed food insecurity as one of the threats that society will endure during this century.

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Words in use

Language focus

Complete the sentences with the words below. Change the form if necessary.

biodiversity	dire	ecologist	insecurity
lessen	overpopulated	undue	unsustainable

5. When a city is _overpopulated_ , the ratio of available resources to the number of people sharply decreases.

6. Many current food systems are _unsustainable_ because they cause significant resource depletion (损耗) and unacceptable environmental impacts.

7. Despite opposing views, proponents considered overpopulation a (n) ___dire___ threat to the entire planet.

8. Climate change can be overwhelming. It is necessary to think about your effects on the environment and the steps you can take to _lessen_ that impact.

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Translation

Language focus

Translate the following sentences into Chinese. Pay attention to the words in bold.

1. According to the International Monetary Fund (国际货币基金组织), the **redistribution** of income might achieve not only greater equality but also faster growth and, for developing economies, faster poverty reduction.

   国际货币基金组织认为，收入再分配不仅可能实现更大程度的平等，还可能实现更快的增长，对发展中经济体来说，还可能更快地消除贫困。

2. Some researchers argue that overpopulation leads to a state of food insecurity that induces the evolution of resource-exhausted agriculture, causing **irreparable** environmental damages.

   一些研究人员认为，人口过剩会导致粮食不安全状况的出现，进而会诱发资源枯竭型农业的演变，造成难以挽回的环境破坏。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Translation

Language focus

3. Poor air and water quality, **insufficient** water availability, waste-disposal problems, and high energy consumption are exacerbated (使恶化；使加剧) by the increasing population density.

人口密度的增加造成了空气和水质变差、水资源短缺、垃圾处理问题、高耗能等一系列问题的恶化。

4. **Exponential** growth in population may occur in environments where there are few individuals and plentiful resources, but when the number of individuals becomes large enough, resources will be depleted, slowing the growth rate.

在个体数量少而资源丰富的情况下可能出现人口数量的指数级增长，但当个体数量规模足够大时，资源就会枯竭，从而延缓人口的增长速度。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

01

Just 2.5% of the world's water is fresh, with much of that caught up in polar ice caps (University of Michigan, 2000). **(Para. 3, Argument A)**

此句中much of that指much of the world's fresh water；这里是with + *n.* / *pron.* + done结构作伴随状语，其中谓语动词caught的逻辑主语为much of that。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

02

Should water become even scarcer, this is likely to grow further.
(Para. 3, Argument A)

此句中should表示“可能（用于表示某事可能会发生或属实）”，should water become even scarcer相当于if water becomes even scarcer，should 提前到句首形成倒装结构，比if结构更为正式。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

03

How can we allow such environmental degradation to occur under our noses? (Para. 4, Argument A)

短语under one's nose为惯用语，意为sb. fails to see or notice sth. even though he or she should，表示“当着某人的面，在某人眼皮底下（却没有被察觉）”。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

04

This will make it more difficult for people to afford food, heating, and other manufactured goods, placing more people into poverty.
(Para. 5, Argument A)

此句中it为形式宾语，真正宾语为people后面的不定式短语to afford food, heating, and other manufactured goods；现在分词短语placing more people into poverty作结果状语。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

05

We must stop burying our heads in the sand and make a sustained effort to reduce population growth. **(Para. 6, Argument A)**

短语bury one's head in the sand为固定用法，意为to ignore an unpleasant situation and hope it will stop if you do not think about it（采取鸵鸟政策，逃避现实）。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

06

The UN estimates that in less developed countries where women are not educated, they have twice as many children as in those countries where women are educated. **(Para. 6, Argument A)**

动词estimate后的宾语从句结构较为复杂，其中包含两个where引导的定语从句，分别修饰先行词less developed countries以及those countries；twice as many A as B 为英语倍数表达中的常用结构，意为“A是B的两倍，或A比B多一倍”，再比如twice as many boys as girls，意为“男孩是女孩的两倍，或男孩比女孩多一倍”。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

07

In most cases, it is the low variant that has come true in the past, suggesting the same will be true of their future population predictions. **(Para. 2, Argument B)**

此句中主干部分为it is the low variant that has come true in the past，用了强调句型it is … that …，强调的内容是the low variant，其一般语序为the low variant has come true in the past。现在分词结构suggesting … 作结果状语，此处suggest后跟了一个宾语从句，其引导词that被省略。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

08

The average woman now has 2.4 children (World Bank, 2015), which is very close to the replacement level of 2.3. **(Para. 2, Argument B)**

此句中replacement level表示“生育更替水平”。当生育率与死亡率基本相等时，总人口就保持不增加也不减少的态势，这时的生育水平称为更替水平。生育率的更替水平取决于人口分年龄段的死亡率水平。按照当前世界多数国家分年龄死亡率计算，妇女终身生育率的更替水平在2.2–2.4之间。如果平均每个妇女生育的子女数超过或者低于这个水平，人口便继续增长或者减少。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

09

The World Food Programme (n.d.) confirms that there is sufficient food grown to feed the world and there is the same amount of fresh water on the planet now as there was 10,000 years ago … **(Para. 3, Argument B)**

过去分词短语grown to feed the world 作定语修饰food。在the same … as … 结构中，as后面可接名词、代词、短语或从句，本句中接的是从句there was 10,000 years ago。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

10

With more countries set to generate greater wealth, there is bound to be an exponential increase in overconsumption in the future, so we must be prepared today. **(Para. 5, Argument B)**

此句主体部分为并列句，由连词so连接。第一个子句中，句式there is bound to be … 意为“必定，一定会”；另外，with more countries set to generate greater wealth作原因状语，相当于as more countries are set to generate greater wealth。